

01

UMĀSVĀTI / UMĀSVĀMĪ AND THE TATTVĀRTHASŪTRA □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ The Tattvārthasūtra or Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra of Umāsvāti in Śvetāmbara usage and Umāsvāmī in Digambara usage is the first systematic Sanskrit exposition of Jaina philosophy and is authoritative for both major sects.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Its cross-sectarian authority is unusual because Śvetāmbara and Digambara traditions often differ in scriptural canon and practice.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ A UPSC answer improves when Jainism is presented as a systematic darśana rather than as a loose collection of ascetic practices.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ The Tattvārthasūtra or Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra of Umāsvāti in Śvetāmbara usage and Umāsvāmī in Digambara usage is the first systematic Sanskrit exposition of Jaina philosophy and is authoritative for both major sects.

02

THEORY OF REALITY □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring dravya (substance) possesses guṇa (qualities) and changing paryāya (modes).

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Recommended opening definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring dravya (substance) possesses guṇa (qualities) and changing paryāya (modes).

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03

1. Anekāntavāda as metaphysical thesis

03

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CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Anekāntavāda is the Jaina doctrine that reality is many-sided; no single unqualified proposition exhausts the nature of a real thing.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Real things endure through change and exhibit multiple aspects.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Dogmatic one-sided claims therefore distort reality.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ Anekāntavāda is not mere indecision.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Anekāntavāda is the Jaina doctrine that reality is many-sided; no single unqualified proposition exhausts the nature of a real thing.

04

2 Dravya as sat = utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ The real (sat) is what possesses utpāda (origination), vyaya (decay), and dhrauvya (persistence or permanence) together.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Experience also shows continuity: something persists through those changes.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore reality must include both persistence and modification.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Pure permanence cannot explain transformation.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ The real (sat) is what possesses utpāda (origination), vyaya (decay), and dhrauvya (persistence or permanence) together.

05

3 Six dravyas □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

2. □ Jainism is therefore pluralistic without being chaotic: each dravya has a distinct explanatory function.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

4. □ Kāla (time) is a real dravya in the mainstream sixfold presentation, but it is not an astikāya; hence Jainism speaks of pañcāstikāya plus kāla.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Jainism classically recognizes six dravyas: jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa, and kāla.

06

4 Guṇa and paryāya □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Therefore it is intelligible as substance-with-qualities-and-modes.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Therefore it is intelligible as substance-with-qualities-and-modes.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore it is intelligible as substance-with-qualities-and-modes.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

A substance must have stable features or it would not be what it is.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Every dravya possesses guṇa (essential qualities) and paryāya (modes or modifications).

07

5 Jīva and ajīva □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ The most fundamental ontological distinction is between jīva (conscious) and ajīva (non-conscious).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

This distinction is ontologically basic because consciousness cannot be reduced to inert matter in Jaina thought.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Distinction. □ Unlike Advaita, this is not a distinction within one underlying Brahman.

08

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MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Distinction. □ Unlike Advaita, this is not a distinction within one underlying Brahman.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

This distinction is ontologically basic because consciousness cannot be reduced to inert matter in Jaina thought.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ The most fundamental ontological distinction is between jīva (conscious) and ajīva (non-conscious).

6 Nature of jīva □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Every jīva is distinct, beginningless, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, and power, though these are obscured by karma.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ Every jīva is distinct, beginningless, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, and power, though these are obscured by karma.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore jīva is intrinsically luminous but contingently covered.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Bondage is then understood as obscuration, not total annihilation of that nature.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Every jīva is distinct, beginningless, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, and power, though these are obscured by karma.

09

7 Pudgala □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Pudgala is the material dravya and the only dravya possessing rūpa (form); it includes atoms, bodies, sense-objects, and karmic matter.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Matter must therefore be treated as a real and irreducible category.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Materiality is not illusory; it is an objective domain with its own laws.

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1 Primary division: pratyakṣa and parokṣa □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. □ In the strict Jaina sense, pratyakṣa means knowledge that the soul knows directly without mediation by senses or mind.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ In the strict Jaina sense, pratyakṣa means knowledge that the soul knows directly without mediation by senses or mind.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Ordinary sense-perception is therefore not ultimate direct knowledge; it is only sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa (empirical or conventional direct knowledge).

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

2. □ Ordinary sense-perception is therefore not ultimate direct knowledge; it is only sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa (empirical or conventional direct knowledge).

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Jaina epistemology distinguishes pratyakṣa (direct knowledge) and parokṣa (indirect knowledge), but it uses the word pratyakṣa in a high-yield, non-ordinary way.

2 Five kinds of jñāna □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Presupposition. □□ Knowledge is graded according to the degree to which karmic obscuration is removed.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ Mati and śruta are mediated and therefore indirect in the strict classification.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

1. □ Mati and śruta are mediated and therefore indirect in the strict classification.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ The five jñānas are not five independent pramāṇas in the Nyāya sense; they are Jaina modes of knowledge mapped to bondage and purification.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Jainism classically enumerates five kinds of jñāna (knowledge): mati, śruta, avadhi, manahparyāya, and kevala.

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ANSWER LINE: Statement. ❑ Jainism classically enumerates five kinds of jñāna (knowledge): mati, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyāya, and kevala.

3 Wrong cognition: ajñāna under mithyā-darśana ❑

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

- ❑ Wrongness is not always the mere absence of content.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

- ❑❑ The content may have some descriptive accuracy, but its orientation is false because it is governed by delusion.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

- ❑ Cognition becomes spiritually wrong when held under mithyā-darśana (false vision or wrong orientation).

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

- ❑ Wrongness is not always the mere absence of content.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. ❑ Jainism recognizes mati-ajñāna or kumati, śruta-ajñāna or kuśruta, and vibhaṅga-jñāna as wrong cognition.

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4 Later Jaina logic and indirect pramāṇas ❑❑

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

- ❑ This is a notable contrast with Nyāya, which does not treat memory as an independent pramāṇa.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

- ❑ Akalaṅka, Māṇikyanandi, Hemacandra, and Yaśovijaya are important names for the developed Jaina pramāṇa tradition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

- ❑ This is a notable contrast with Nyāya, which does not treat memory as an independent pramāṇa.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

- ❑ This is a notable contrast with Nyāya, which does not treat memory as an independent pramāṇa.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. ❑ Jainism admits anumāna (inference) and śabda (testimony or verbal authority) within parokṣa, and later Jaina logicians give a richer account of indirect knowledge.

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5 Critical link: pramāṇa → navavāda → svādvāda ❑

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5 Critical link: pramāṇa → nayavāda → syādvāda □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Anekāntavāda is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Ordinary human cognition is kṣāyopaśamika (arising from partial destruction-cum-subsidence of knowledge-obscuring karma), and is therefore necessarily partial.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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SAPTABHAṄGĪNAYA □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication) expresses syādvāda (doctrine of conditional assertion) by qualifying every judgement through a standpoint, thereby avoiding both dogmatic absolutism and sceptical silence.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication) expresses syādvāda (doctrine of conditional assertion) by qualifying every judgement through a standpoint, thereby avoiding both dogmatic absolutism and sceptical silence.

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1 Nayavāda: standpoint-theory

16

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CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

A doctrine of standpoints is needed to explain how partial truth is possible.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Therefore judgements are aspectual, not exhaustive.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore judgements are aspectual, not exhaustive.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Therefore judgements are aspectual, not exhaustive.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Nayavāda teaches that every ordinary judgement expresses a *naya*, a standpoint that captures one aspect of the real.

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2 The seven nayas □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Classical Jainism enumerates seven nayas, each marking a characteristic standpoint.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Reply. □□ They matter because many philosophical disputes are verbal absolutizations of context-bound usage.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Presupposition. □□ Language itself contributes to one-sidedness if its scope is not critically examined.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Language itself contributes to one-sidedness if its scope is not critically examined.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Classical Jainism enumerates seven nayas, each marking a characteristic standpoint.

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3 Syādvāda as logical expression

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Syādvāda is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification *syāt*—"in some respect," "from a certain standpoint," or "conditionally."

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Since reality is many-sided, categorical assertion is risky.

3 Syādvāda as logical expression

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Statement. □ Syādvāda is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification syāt—"in some respect," "from a certain standpoint," or "conditionally."

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Since reality is many-sided, categorical assertion is risky.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Since judgements arise from standpoints, language must register conditionality.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Statement. □ Syādvāda is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification syāt—"in some respect," "from a certain standpoint," or "conditionally."

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Syādvāda is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification syāt—"in some respect," "from a certain standpoint," or "conditionally."

4 Saptabhaṅgī: the seven predications, exactly and in order □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ The saptabhaṅgī is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier syāt.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. syād nāsti — in some respect, it is not.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

6. syād nāsti ca avaktavyam — in some respect, it is not and is indescribable.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ The saptabhaṅgī is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier syāt.

5 Blind men and the elephant □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Presupposition. □□ Cognitive violence begins when a part is mistaken for the whole.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Argument. □□ The illustration dramatizes the difference between partial correctness and exclusive completeness.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Presupposition. □□ Cognitive violence begins when a part is mistaken for the whole.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Argument. □□ The illustration dramatizes the difference between partial correctness and exclusive completeness.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Presupposition. □□ Cognitive violence begins when a part is mistaken for the whole.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ The parable illustrates non-absolutism; it is not itself the formal doctrine.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ The familiar illustration of the blind men and the elephant captures the spirit of *anekāntavāda*: each grasped part yields a partial truth wrongly elevated into a whole truth.

6 Five kinds of knowledge □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Presupposition. □□ Knowledge is not uniform; it has degrees according to the soul's purity.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Argument. □ The gradation maps the progressive removal of karmic obstruction from cognition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Presupposition. □□ Knowledge is not uniform; it has degrees according to the soul's purity.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Knowledge is not uniform; it has degrees according to the soul's purity.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Jaina epistemology commonly speaks of five kinds of knowledge: *mati*, *śruta*, *avadhi*, *manahparyāya*, and *kevala*.

7 Standard objection: is *anekāntavāda* self-refuting or trivial? □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Critics argue either that *anekāntavāda* is self-refuting—because the claim that “all reality is many-sided” is itself made absolutely—or trivial, because everyone already admits contextual variation.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

If qualified, it may lose universal force.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Jainism need not deny that the doctrine itself is also expressible from a standpoint.

If qualified, it may lose universal force.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Critics argue either that *anekāntavāda* is self-refuting—because the claim that “all reality is many-sided” is itself made absolutely—or trivial, because everyone already admits contextual variation.

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8 Does Jaina non-absolutism presuppose absolutism? (2022) □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □□ A standard challenge says that to say reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore *anekāntavāda* covertly presupposes absolutism.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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Statement. □□ A standard challenge says that to say reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore *anekāntavāda* covertly presupposes absolutism.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Non-absolutism does not deny more comprehensive knowledge; it denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □□ A standard challenge says that to say reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore *anekāntavāda* covertly presupposes absolutism.

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9 Is Jainism pluralistic and realistic? (2025) □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □□ Yes, Jainism is strongly pluralistic and broadly realistic, though both labels require nuance.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Nuance. □□ Its realism is qualified realism, because judgement is standpoint-indexed.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Liberation is of many individual souls, not absorption into one absolute.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Liberation is of many individual souls, not absorption into one absolute.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □□ Yes, Jainism is strongly pluralistic and broadly realistic, though both labels require nuance.

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ANSWER LINE: Statement. ☐☐ Yes, Jainism is strongly pluralistic and broadly realistic, though both labels require nuance.

BONDAGE AND LIBERATION ☐

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Jaina bondage begins when āsrava (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bandha (bondage) binds it; saṃvara (stoppage) and nirjarā (shedding) culminate in mokṣa (liberation).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jaina bondage begins when āsrava (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bandha (bondage) binds it; saṃvara (stoppage) and nirjarā (shedding) culminate in mokṣa (liberation).

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Jaina bondage begins when āsrava (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bandha (bondage) binds it; saṃvara (stoppage) and nirjarā (shedding) culminate in mokṣa (liberation).

ANSWER LINE: Jaina bondage begins when āsrava (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bandha (bondage) binds it; saṃvara (stoppage) and nirjarā (shedding) culminate in mokṣa (liberation).

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1 Karma as subtle material substance

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. ☐ Jainism's distinctive doctrine is that karma is a subtle material substance, a form of pudgala that flows toward and binds the soul.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

This obscuration requires a real binding factor.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Thus bondage is ontologically real, not merely metaphorical.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

That factor is karma, conceived not merely as moral tendency but as fine material accretion.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. ☐ Jainism's distinctive doctrine is that karma is a subtle material substance, a form of pudgala that flows toward and binds the soul.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Jainism's distinctive doctrine is that karma is a subtle material substance, a form of pudgala that flows toward and binds the soul.

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2 The fivefold soteriological sequence □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ The Jaina path is commonly described through the sequence āsrava → bandha → saṃvara → nirjarā → mokṣa.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ The Jaina path is commonly described through the sequence āsrava → bandha → saṃvara → nirjarā → mokṣa.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Austerity and purification burn off old karma.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ Saṃvara and nirjarā are not the same: one stops new karma; the other removes old karma.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ The Jaina path is commonly described through the sequence āsrava → bandha → saṃvara → nirjarā → mokṣa.

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3 Bhāvabandha and dravyabandha (2024) □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

This inner deformation is bhāvabandha.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The soul first undergoes affective-volitional corruption through passions, attachment, aversion, delusion, and wrong disposition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Thus psychic and material bondage are distinct yet interlinked.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Objection (analytical objection). □ Why not collapse them into one process?

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Bondage has two closely related forms: bhāvabandha (psychic bondage) and dravyabandha (material bondage).

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4 The three jewels □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Presupposition. □□ Cognitive, affective, and practical transformation are inseparable.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

4 The three jewels □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Presupposition. □□ Cognitive, affective, and practical transformation are inseparable.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ Liberation requires the three jewels (ratnatraya): samyag-darśana (right faith/vision), samyag-jñāna (right knowledge), and samyag-cāritra (right conduct).

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

One must live in accordance with that insight.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Mere knowledge without conduct does not stop karmic influx.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Liberation requires the three jewels (ratnatraya): samyag-darśana (right faith/vision), samyag-jñāna (right knowledge), and samyag-cāritra (right conduct).

5 Five mahāvratas □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Right conduct is classically articulated through the five mahāvratas: ahimsā, satya, asteya, brahmacharya, and aparigraha.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ Right conduct is classically articulated through the five mahāvratas: ahimsā, satya, asteya, brahmacharya, and aparigraha.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Argument. □ These vows reduce passions, prevent harmful activity, and therefore check karmic influx.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Ethical discipline is metaphysically effective, not merely socially good.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Right conduct is classically articulated through the five mahāvratas: ahimsā, satya, asteya, brahmacharya, and aparigraha.

6 Kevala-jñāna □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Kevala-jñāna is perfect knowledge or omniscience attained when the obstructive karmas are fully destroyed.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Therefore kevala-jñāna is revelation of what the soul truly is.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Therefore kevala-jñāna is revelation of what the soul truly is.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore kevala-jñāna is revelation of what the soul truly is.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Perfection is recovery, not production ex nihilo.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Kevala-jñāna is perfect knowledge or omniscience attained when the obstructive karmas are fully destroyed.

7 Mokṣa □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Mokṣa is the final state in which the soul is freed from all karmic matter, regains infinite knowledge, bliss, power, and perception, and rises to siddha-śilā.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Being no longer weighed down by karmic matter, it rises to the topmost region of the cosmos.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Distinction. □ Unlike Advaita mokṣa, this is not merger into impersonal Brahman.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ Unlike Advaita mokṣa, this is not merger into impersonal Brahman.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Mokṣa is the final state in which the soul is freed from all karmic matter, regains infinite knowledge, bliss, power, and perception, and rises to siddha-śilā.

1 Seven tattvas □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

6. □ Mokṣa names the final state when all karmic bondage is absent.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Example. □ A person's anger is not merely a mental event; it opens āsrava, deepens bandha, and must be countered by saṃvara and nirjarā.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Āsrava explains how karmic matter flows toward the soul.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Metaphysics is organized around soteriology: the list is not merely classificatory but therapeutic.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Āsrava explains how karmic matter flows toward the soul.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Metaphysics is organized around soteriology: the list is not merely classificatory but therapeutic.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ The seven tattvas (real categories for liberation-analysis) are jīva, ajīva, āsrava, bandha, saṃvara, nirjarā, and mokṣa.

2 Nine padārthas □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Distinction. □ Puṇya is better than pāpa ethically, but both are to be transcended for mokṣa.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ Puṇya and pāpa are ethically important because meritorious and demeritorious states affect karmic bondage.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □□ They can also be subsumed under āsrava and bandha because both merit and demerit are forms of karmic involvement.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Example. □ Charity performed with attachment may produce puṇya, but liberation requires non-attachment rather than pleasant rebirth alone.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ The nine padārthas are the same seven tattvas plus puṇya (merit) and pāpa (demerit).

3 Soteriological flow: liberation by subtraction □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Jaina liberation is primarily a matter of subtraction, not acquisition: the soul's ananta-catuṣṭaya (infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss, infinite power) is revealed when karmic obstruction is removed.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

3. □ Kevala-jñāna is therefore revealed rather than produced.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. □ Kevala-jñāna is therefore revealed rather than produced.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Statement. □ Jaina liberation is primarily a matter of subtraction, not acquisition: the soul's ananta-catuṣṭaya (infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss, infinite power) is revealed when karmic obstruction is removed.

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1 Karma is material pudgala □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Jainism's philosophically distinctive thesis is that karma is literally material: karma-pudgala is subtle matter that flows into and adheres to the soul.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Jainism explains them through subtle material karmas rather than through an invisible moral potency alone.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

4. □ Thus passions and activities have ontological consequences, not merely psychological consequences.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

2. □ Jainism explains them through subtle material karmas rather than through an invisible moral potency alone.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Jainism's philosophically distinctive thesis is that karma is literally material: karma-pudgala is subtle matter that flows into and adheres to the soul.

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2 Eight basic karma-prakṛtis □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

3. □ Mohanīya is the most dangerous because delusion corrupts both right vision and right conduct.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. □ Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya, and antarāya are ghātiyā because they obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation, and power.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Vedanīya, nāma, gotra, and āyus are aghātiyā because they structure embodied experience, body, status, and lifespan.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ Liberation requires not only moral improvement but precise removal of the karmic veils that obstruct the soul's essential nature.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ The eight karmas divide into ghātiyā karmas, which damage or obscure the soul's essential qualities, and aghātiyā karmas, which determine embodiment without directly destroying those qualities.

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3 Four parameters of bandha □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Karmic bondage is analysed through four parameters: prakṛti (type or nature), sthiti (duration), anubhāga or rasa (intensity), and pradeśa (quantity of karmic matter).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ Karmic bondage is analysed through four parameters: prakṛti (type or nature), sthiti (duration), anubhāga or rasa (intensity), and pradeśa (quantity of karmic matter).

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. □ Activity without passion therefore has a radically different karmic effect from activity with passion.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Presupposition. □□ The moral weight of an action depends not only on external movement but on passion, attachment, and delusion.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Karmic bondage is analysed through four parameters: prakṛti (type or nature), sthiti (duration), anubhāga or rasa (intensity), and pradeśa (quantity of karmic matter).

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1 Ordered list □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

2. □ Stage 4 is decisive because samyag-darśana first becomes stable enough to orient the path.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ Stage 4 is decisive because samyag-darśana first becomes stable enough to orient the path.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Distinction. □ Stage 4 is a breakthrough in right vision; it is not yet complete ascetic conduct.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ The guṇasthānas are fourteen ordered stages marking the soul's gradual movement from delusion to omniscience and final liberation.

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2 Two ladders and jīvanmukti □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Jaina doctrine distinguishes upaśama-śreṇi (ladder of suppression) and kṣanaka-śreṇi (ladder of annihilation); only the annihilation ladder reaches irreversible destruction of delusion.

2 Two ladders and jīvanmukti □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Jaina doctrine distinguishes upaśama-śreṇi (ladder of suppression) and kṣapaka-śreṇi (ladder of annihilation); only the annihilation ladder reaches irreversible destruction of delusion.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Stage 11 necessarily falls back because suppressed moha is not destroyed.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Jaina doctrine distinguishes upaśama-śreṇi (ladder of suppression) and kṣapaka-śreṇi (ladder of annihilation); only the annihilation ladder reaches irreversible destruction of delusion.

SALLEKHANĀ / SANTHĀRĀ: DEATH WITHOUT PASSION □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Sallekhanā or santhārā is the voluntary, gradual, ritually regulated relinquishment of food and passions undertaken when death is unavoidable or bodily decline is incurable.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Distinction. □ Jainism distinguishes sallekhanā from ātma-ghāta (suicide): suicide is passion-driven, sudden, violent, often concealed, and motivated by despair or aversion; sallekhanā is passion-free, non-violent, gradual, supervised, and public.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ A death faced with equanimity minimizes new influx and prevents panic, attachment, and aversion from creating fresh bondage.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Statement. □ Sallekhanā or santhārā is the voluntary, gradual, ritually regulated relinquishment of food and passions undertaken when death is unavoidable or bodily decline is incurable.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Sallekhanā or santhārā is the voluntary, gradual, ritually regulated relinquishment of food and passions undertaken when death is unavoidable or bodily decline is incurable.

INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita (non-dualism) by defending a many-sided reality of enduring substances that genuinely undergo changing modes.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita (non-dualism) by defending a many-sided reality of enduring substances that genuinely undergo changing modes.

ANSWER LINE: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita (non-dualism) by defending a many-sided reality of enduring substances that genuinely undergo changing modes.

NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAINA REPLIES □**CONTEXT + EXACT CORE**

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The charge that anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) is self-refuting fails if its own claim is understood as standpoint-qualified rather than as an unqualified absolute denial of absolutes.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The charge that anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) is self-refuting fails if its own claim is understood as standpoint-qualified rather than as an unqualified absolute denial of absolutes.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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1 Śaṅkara's critique of anekāntavāda □**CONTEXT + EXACT CORE**

1 □ If the same object is said to be both existent and non-existent, determinate knowledge is threatened

1 Śaṃkara's critique of anekāntavāda □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

- If the same object is said to be both existent and non-existent, determinate knowledge is threatened.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Statement. □ Śaṃkara, in the Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya, criticizes Jaina anekāntavāda by arguing that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

- If everything is "somehow yes and somehow no," practical action loses clear guidance.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Statement. □ Śaṃkara, in the Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya, criticizes Jaina anekāntavāda by arguing that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Śaṃkara, in the Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya, criticizes Jaina anekāntavāda by arguing that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way.

2 Rāmānuja's critique: opposed real attributes □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Rāmānuja presses the charge that a real substance with really opposed attributes is unintelligible.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

- A thing cannot be genuinely both F and not-F in the same meaningful sense.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

- If the attributes are real and opposed, the substance becomes incoherent.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

- A thing cannot be genuinely both F and not-F in the same meaningful sense.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Rāmānuja presses the charge that a real substance with really opposed attributes is unintelligible.

3 Dharmakīrti / Buddhist critique of permanent-yet-changing soul □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

- If the soul expands and contracts with the body, it undergoes real change.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Jaina reply. □ Jainism replies through utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya: origination, cessation, and permanence are simultaneously real features of every sat; the substance is permanent qua dravya and changing qua paryāya.

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

- If the soul expands and contracts with the body, it undergoes real change.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Jaina reply. □ Jainism replies through utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya: origination, cessation, and permanence are simultaneously real features of every sat; the substance is permanent qua dravya and changing qua paryāya.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

- What undergoes real change cannot be absolutely permanent.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

- What undergoes real change cannot be absolutely permanent.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ A Buddhist critique associated with Dharmakīrti's causal-efficacy style of argument challenges the Jaina soul as permanent yet changing.

4 Nyāya critique of the soul's expansion and material karma □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ Nyāya criticizes the Jaina view that the soul is co-extensive with the body and expands or contracts like a lamp filling a room.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

- An eternal self should not literally expand and contract.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

- If the self has parts or pradeśas, its eternality seems threatened.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

- An eternal self should not literally expand and contract.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Nyāya criticizes the Jaina view that the soul is co-extensive with the body and expands or contracts like a lamp filling a room.

5 Sāṃkhya/Vedānta critique of intrinsic omniscience and beginningless bondage □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

- If the soul is intrinsically pure and omniscient, obscuration appears accidental and inexplicable.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

- If the soul is intrinsically pure and omniscient, obscuration appears accidental and inexplicable.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

- If karma began at some time, a first cause of bondage is required.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

- If karma never began, liberation may seem impossible.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. □ If karma began at some time, a first cause of bondage is required.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

3. □ If karma never began, liberation may seem impossible.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ Sāṃkhya and Vedānta-style objections ask why karmic matter obscures an intrinsically omniscient soul and what began the obscuration.

6 Cārvāka / empiricist critique of omniscience and liberation □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Statement. □ A Cārvāka or modern empiricist objection rejects invisible souls, karmic particles, omniscience, and siddha-śilā as unverifiable.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Argument of the critic. □ Ordinary perception does not disclose karmic matter, disembodied siddhas, or omniscient cognition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Presupposition. □□ Only publicly verifiable empirical entities should be admitted.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Argument of the critic. □ Ordinary perception does not disclose karmic matter, disembodied siddhas, or omniscient cognition.

ANSWER LINE: Statement. □ A Cārvāka or modern empiricist objection rejects invisible souls, karmic particles, omniscience, and siddha-śilā as unverifiable.

COMMON UPSC TRAPS □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Karma in Jainism is material (pudgala). □ Do not reduce it to generic moral force or adṛṣṭa.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Sayoga-kevalī = Jaina jīvanmukta. □ Omniscience can occur while embodied because aghātiyā karmas remain until final siddhatva.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Six dravyas, but only five astikāyas. □ Kāla is a dravya but not an astikāya; the pañcāstikāya list has five members while the dravya list has six.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Karma in Jainism is material (pudgala). □ Do not reduce it to generic moral force or adṛṣṭa.

ANSWER LINE: Anekāntavāda ≠ syādvāda ≠ saptabhaṅgī. □ Metaphysics / epistemic-logical method / formal sevenfold predication.

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KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Anekāntavāda — doctrine of many-sided reality. □

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Exam sentence: "Jaina realism is qualified not because reality is doubtful, but because finite judgement reaches the real only under conditioned standpoints." □□

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Dravya-guṇa-paryāya — substance, qualities, modes. □

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Exam sentence: "Jaina realism is qualified not because reality is doubtful, but because finite judgement reaches the real only under conditioned standpoints." □□

ANSWER LINE: Anekāntavāda — doctrine of many-sided reality. □

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Bound and liberated soul

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Bondage: karmic matter flows toward the jīva through activity and passions, becomes bound to it, obscures its infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, and determines embodiment.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Bondage: karmic matter flows toward the jīva through activity and passions, becomes bound to it, obscures its infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, and determines embodiment.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□□ Distinction: the liberated soul is not merged into a universal consciousness; numerical individuality survives without karmic limitation.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ Distinction: the liberated soul is not merged into a universal consciousness; numerical individuality survives without karmic limitation.

ANSWER LINE: □ Bondage: karmic matter flows toward the jīva through activity and passions, becomes bound to it, obscures its infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, and determines embodiment.

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CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018–2025 audit)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□□ Priority: Primary ownership rises to 9 of 112 parts and occurs in every year.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Required doctrinal depth: The restored papers require the mechanics of bondage, bound versus liberated soul, the condition of the siddha, and karma's direct bearing on liberation.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ Trap / answer consequence: Do not reduce liberation to moral improvement alone: map influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and the persistence of perfected individual jīva.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ Trap / answer consequence: Do not reduce liberation to moral improvement alone: map influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and the persistence of perfected individual jīva.

ANSWER LINE: □□ Priority: Primary ownership rises to 9 of 112 parts and occurs in every year.

INTER-SCHOOL POSITIONING □

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Focused Jainism vs Buddhism. □ Both are śramaṇa traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator God. □ Jainism, however, affirms many permanent jīvas and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects substance-self. □ Jaina ahiṃsā is far more radical because even minute living beings are jīvas. □ Jaina karma is material karma-pudgala, while Buddhist karma is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. □□ Thus the two are close historically but sharply opposed metaphysically.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Focused Jainism vs Buddhism. □ Both are śramaṇa traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator God. □ Jainism, however, affirms many permanent jīvas and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects substance-self. □ Jaina ahiṃsā is far more radical because even minute living beings are jīvas. □ Jaina karma is material karma-pudgala, while Buddhist karma is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. □□ Thus the two are close historically but sharply opposed metaphysically.

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CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISON □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Rubric. □□ Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Jaina argument; use at most one or two lines after the Jaina case is complete.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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GRADED VERDICT ON JAINISM □□

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

3. □ Its material karma doctrine makes ethics causally serious and connects metaphysics with ascetic practice.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. □ Modern legal-ethical evaluation of sallekhanā requires case-specific verification before citing details.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. □ Its material karma doctrine makes ethics causally serious and connects metaphysics with ascetic practice.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

4. □ Its ahimsā follows directly from plural jīvas and karmic bondage, not from sentiment alone.

ANSWER LINE: 1. □ Jainism gives one of the clearest Indian accounts of how permanence and change can both be real.

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ANSWER LINE: Focused Jainism vs Buddhism. □ Both are śramaṇa traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator God. □ Jainism, however, affirms many permanent jīvas and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects substance-self. □ Jaina ahimsā is far more radical because even minute living beings are jīvas. □ Jaina karma is material karma-pudgala, while Buddhist karma is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. □□ Thus the two are close historically but sharply opposed metaphysically.

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3. □ Its material karma doctrine makes ethics causally serious and connects metaphysics with ascetic practice.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

4. □ Its ahimsā follows directly from plural jīvas and karmic bondage, not from sentiment alone.

ANSWER LINE: 1. □ Jainism gives one of the clearest Indian accounts of how permanence and change can both be real.